

Rethinking parenting and education in a changing world

In today's **fiercely** competitive and fast-changing world, education is **often** considered the foundation of a child's future. Across India and **indeed** globally-academic achievement is frequently regarded as the most reliable indicator of success. Parents **go to great lengths** to ensure their children **excel**, investing in private tutoring, enrolling them in competitive exams, and tracking every grade with **meticulous** attention. While such efforts are **driven** by love and ambition, this **narrow** focus on academics can be limiting.

A child is not a container to be filled with facts, but a unique individual whose personality, emotional well-being, and character must be **nurtured**. As the saying goes, "**All work and no play makes Jack a dull boy.**" Parenting, therefore, extends far beyond report cards. It is a long-term responsibility that **encompasses** emotional support, value-building, and preparing children to **navigate** life's **inevitable ups and downs**.

The COVID-19 pandemic **exposed** many **cracks** in our educational and parenting **frameworks**. With schools closed and routines disrupted, parents had to assume multiple roles: educators, emotional anchors, and constant **companions**. In India, this challenge was **compounded** by the digital divide—many children, particularly in rural or economically **disadvantaged** communities, lacked access to online education. This dual burden—academic continuity and mental well-being—brought into sharp focus the need for a more **holistic** and **inclusive** approach to parenting and education.

Today, the world values more than just academic knowledge. Employers and institutions are increasingly **seeking** individuals who **exhibit** creativity, emotional intelligence, **adaptability**, and critical thinking. India's National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 recognises this evolution, promoting a **well-rounded** educational model. But policies alone cannot drive change. It is parents who must **embrace** and **embody** these principles at home, encouraging children to explore their interests be it music, sports, art, or entrepreneurship—and helping them build a strong sense of self-worth and purpose.

Mental health, once a **hush-hush** topic, is finally being **acknowledged** in **mainstream** parenting conversations. Studies reveal that India has among the highest rates of anxiety and depression among **adolescents**. Much of this **stems from** intense academic pressure, limited family communication, and a lack of emotional **validation**. In the age of social media, children are constantly exposed to unrealistic standards and comparisons, further increasing their stress levels. Here, the parent's role is critical. Being a patient listener, **fostering** open dialogue, and normalising failure as part of growth can transform a child's **outlook**. Character development and values are another crucial **aspect** of parenting. Schools can only do so much in **instilling** ethics and good behavior. It is at home that children learn about honesty, kindness, respect, and **empathy** by observing their parents. In a world often defined by **polarisation** and division, these qualities are not just desirable, but essential. Parents must lead by example, because children **imitate** far more than they obey.

In the digital era, guiding children's online behavior has also become a core responsibility. With learning and **leisure** now deeply **intertwined** with technology, parents need to ensure their children develop responsible digital habits. Teaching them to identify reliable information, engage respectfully online, and set boundaries on screen time is vital-especially in a country like India, where digital literacy often **lags** behind digital access.

Cultivating social skills such as teamwork, empathy, and communication at home helps children **thrive** in real-world situations. In an unpredictable world shaped by climate change, economic instability, and shifting job markets, **resilience** and **adaptability** are key life skills. These cannot be learned solely from textbooks. Parents must encourage independent thinking, creative problem-solving, and the ability to **bounce back** from **setbacks**. Life doesn't always go as planned and children need to understand that failure is not a **dead-end**, but an invitation to grow stronger.

In many Indian households, especially among the middle class, academic success is still viewed as the primary path to a secure future. While this belief has **merit**, it should not come at the cost of creativity, curiosity, or emotional well-being. Around the world, parenting models are evolving-Scandinavian approaches emphasise child-led learning, while American systems increasingly integrate mental health and inclusivity. Indian parents, too, must embrace a balanced path that combines timeless values with modern **insights**.

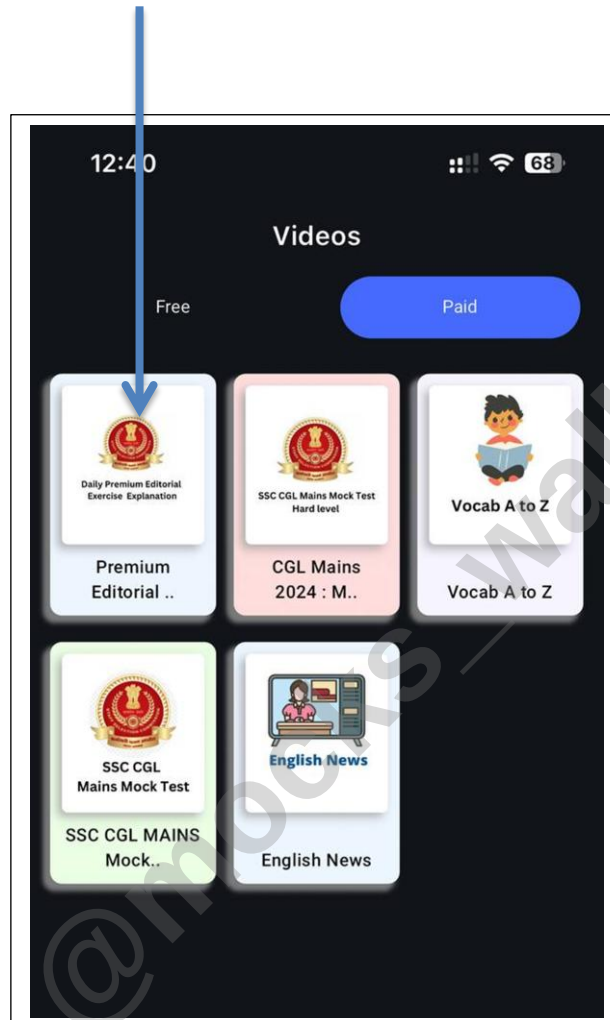
Vocabulary

1. **Fiercely** (adverb) – intensely, aggressively, strongly, passionately, forcefully तीव्रता से
2. **Often** (adverb) – frequently, regularly, commonly, repeatedly, usually अक्सर
3. **Indeed** (adverb) – truly, certainly, really, in fact, undoubtedly वास्तव में
4. **Go to a great length** (phrase) – make every effort, go all out, try hard, strive, exert oneself बहुत प्रयास करना
5. **Excel** (verb) – shine, surpass, outdo, perform well, be outstanding उत्कृष्ट होना
6. **Meticulous** (adjective) – careful, precise, thorough, detailed, painstaking सूक्ष्म / बहुत ध्यान देने वाला
7. **Drive** (verb) – motivate, propel, push, inspire, spur प्रेरित करना
8. **Narrow** (adjective) – limited, restricted, confined, focused, one-sided संकीर्ण
9. **Nurture** (verb) – foster, cultivate, support, care for, encourage पोषण करना / विकसित करना
10. **All work and no play makes Jack a dull boy** (phrase) – overworking without recreation is harmful –सिर्फ काम और कोई खेल नहीं व्यक्ति को नीरस बना देता है
11. **Encompass** (verb) – include, cover, involve, embrace, span समाहित करना
12. **Navigate** (verb) – manage, handle, deal with, steer through, pilot मार्गदर्शन करना / रास्ता निकालना
13. **Inevitable** (adjective) – unavoidable, certain, inescapable, destined, sure अपरिहार्य
14. **Ups and downs** (phrase) – highs and lows, fluctuations, good and bad times, vicissitudes, instability उतार-चढ़ाव
15. **Expose** (verb) – reveal, uncover, show, disclose, unmask उजागर करना
16. **Crack** (noun) – flaw, gap, weakness, fault, fracture दरार / खामी
17. **Framework** (noun) – structure, system, outline, model, scheme ढांचा
18. **Companion** (noun) – friend, partner, ally, associate, confidant साथी
19. **Compound** (verb) – worsen, aggravate, intensify, add to, heighten और गंभीर करना
20. **Disadvantaged** (adjective) – underprivileged, deprived, poor, marginalized, needy वंचित
21. **Holistic** (adjective) – comprehensive, integrated, whole, all-inclusive, complete समग्र

22. **Inclusive** (adjective) – broad, embracing, all-encompassing, open, accessible
समावेशी
23. **Seek** (verb) – look for, pursue, try to find, aim for, strive for प्रयास करना
24. **Exhibit** (verb) – show, display, demonstrate, reveal, present प्रदर्शित करना
25. **Adaptability** (noun) – flexibility, adjustability, versatility, resilience, responsiveness अनुकूलनशीलता
26. **Well-rounded** (adjective) – balanced, comprehensive, multifaceted, versatile, all-around संतुलित
27. **Embrace** (verb) – accept, adopt, welcome, take up, support अपनाना
28. **Embody** (verb) – represent, express, personify, manifest, exemplify मूर्त रूप देना
29. **Hush-hush** (adjective) – secret, confidential, taboo, undisclosed, hidden गुप्त / चुपचाप रखा गया
30. **Acknowledge** (verb) – admit, recognize, accept, appreciate, concede स्वीकार करना
31. **Mainstream** (adjective) – conventional, accepted, prevalent, dominant, established मुख्यधारा का
32. **Adolescent** (noun) – teenager, youth, minor, young person, juvenile किशोर
33. **Stem from** (phrasal verb) – arise from, originate from, result from, come from, derive from से उत्पन्न होना
34. **Validation** (noun) – affirmation, confirmation, approval, recognition, acceptance पुष्टि / मान्यता
35. **Foster** (verb) – nurture, promote, encourage, develop, cultivate बढ़ावा देना
36. **Outlook** (noun) – perspective, view, attitude, approach, mindset दृष्टिकोण
37. **Aspect** (noun) – feature, element, facet, side, component पहलू
38. **Instill** (verb) – impart, inculcate, implant, introduce, infuse भरना / सिखाना
39. **Empathy** (noun) – compassion, understanding, sensitivity, care, kindness सहानुभूति
40. **Polarisation** (noun) – division, separation, split, divergence, conflict ध्रुवीकरण
41. **Imitate** (verb) – copy, mimic, emulate, replicate, follow नकल करना
42. **Leisure** (noun) – free time, recreation, relaxation, downtime, respite अवकाश
43. **Intertwine** (verb) – connect, link, weave together, entangle, join आपस में जुड़ना
44. **Lag** (verb) – fall behind, trail, delay, slow down, drag पिछड़ना

45. **Cultivate** (verb) – develop, nurture, promote, foster, grow विकसित करना
46. **Thrive in** (phrasal verb) – succeed in, flourish in, prosper in, excel in, grow in फलना-फूलना
47. **Resilience** (noun) – toughness, strength, durability, perseverance, adaptability मज़बूती
48. **Adaptability** (noun) – flexibility, adjustability, changeability, responsiveness, resilience अनुकूलनशीलता
49. **Bounce back** (phrasal verb) – recover, rebound, get back, revive, recuperate वापसी करना / फिर उठ खड़ा होना
50. **Setback** (noun) – obstacle, difficulty, hindrance, delay, blow बाधा / असफलता
51. **Dead-end** (noun) – impasse, standstill, halt, block, cul-de-sac गतिरोध / ठहराव
52. **Merit** (noun) – value, worth, excellence, advantage, quality योग्यता
53. **Insight** (noun) – understanding, perception, awareness, realization, comprehension अंतर्दृष्टि / समझ

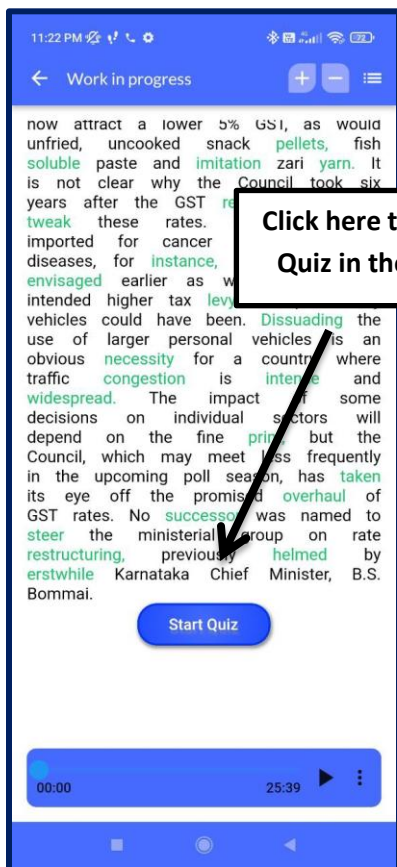
Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.



Summary of the Editorial

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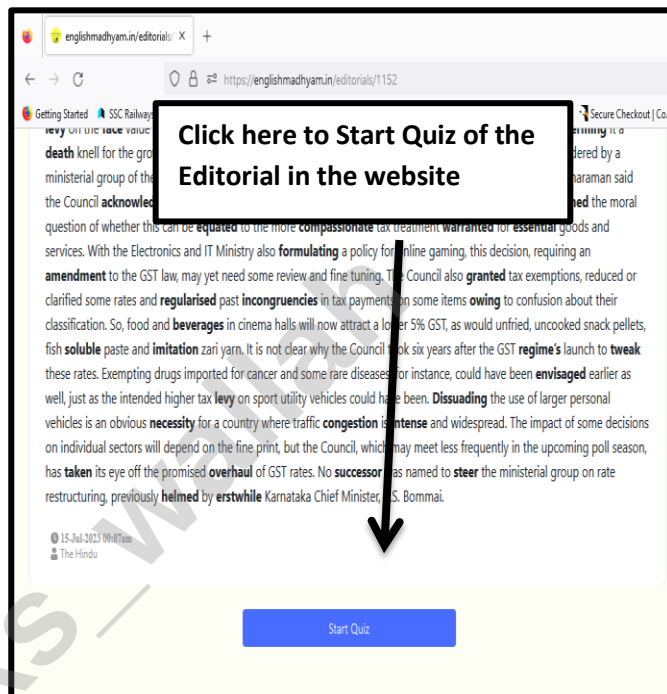
Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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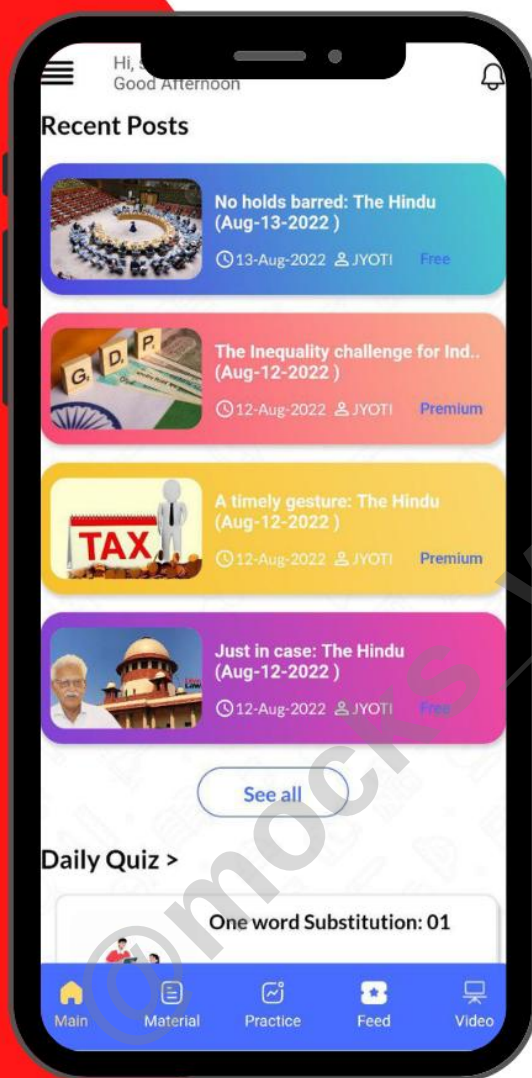
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